The Consumer Protection Act, 2019

Consumer rights, goods and services, unfair practices, product liability and dispute redressal

PROJECT LEGAL REFERENCE DOCUMENT

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Important use note

This project reference edition is prepared for software, AI, data, and academic-project implementation. It summarizes selected provisions and practical implementation implications. It is not an official certified copy, does not replace the current statute, subordinate legislation, notifications, case law, or professional legal advice.

Document metadata

Field	Value
Act number	35 of 2019
Enactment date	9 August 2019
Enforcement	24 July 2020 (for notified provisions)
Department	Department of Consumer Affairs
Official source	India Code
Source version used	India Code: Consumer Protection Act, 2019

Overview

The Consumer Protection Act, 2019 provides for protection of consumer interests and establishes authorities and mechanisms for consumer-dispute administration and settlement. It covers concepts including consumer, goods and services, defects and deficiency, unfair trade practices, product liability, consumer commissions, mediation, and related matters. For digital products, services, subscriptions, marketplaces, and AI-enabled services, the Act can be relevant depending on the parties and transaction.

Selected provisions and project relevance

Section 2

Definitions

Contains important definitions used throughout the Act, including consumer-related terms, goods, services, defect, deficiency, unfair trade practice, and product liability concepts.

Sections 10-21

Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) framework

The Act establishes the CCPA and gives it specified functions and powers concerning consumer interests, unfair trade practices, and related matters.

Sections 28-58

Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions

The Act provides a three-tier commission framework and related jurisdiction and procedure for consumer disputes, subject to the statutory conditions.

Sections 74-81

Mediation

The Act contains provisions establishing consumer mediation mechanisms and related procedures for suitable disputes.

Sections 82-87

Product liability

The Act establishes a product-liability framework and identifies circumstances in which specified parties may be liable for harm caused by defective products or related deficiencies.

Section 89

Punishment for manufacturing or sale of adulterated/spurious goods in certain circumstances

Contains criminal provisions for specified serious consumer-product misconduct. This is relevant mainly to product sectors where such conduct is possible.

Section 94

Measures to prevent unfair trade practices in e-commerce and direct selling

Provides for measures to prevent unfair trade practices in e-commerce and direct selling, with detailed implementation shaped by subordinate rules and regulations.

Project implementation checklist

1. Make product/service descriptions, pricing, material limitations, refund terms, and important conditions clear and consistent across UI, contracts, and marketing.

2. Keep complaint and grievance records linked to orders, subscriptions, or service interactions so disputes can be investigated with evidence.

3. Do not make unsupported performance, accuracy, safety, or outcome claims about AI or software systems.

4. Provide clear channels for complaints, escalation, refund/rectification where applicable, and human contact when automated processes fail.

5. For e-commerce or direct-selling deployments, review the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020 and other applicable rules separately.

6. For high-impact or regulated services, identify any additional sector regulator, product-safety, privacy, or professional-liability requirements.

Suggested RAG / search queries

"Who is a consumer under the 2019 Act?"

"What is the difference between defect and deficiency?"

"What does the product-liability chapter cover?"

"What role does the CCPA play?"

"What additional rules may apply to e-commerce?"

Source and verification

Primary source: India Code, the official Government of India legislative information portal. The source used for this reference edition is listed below. Verify the latest consolidated text and all applicable amendments, rules, notifications, and judgments before real-world reliance.

https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15256/1/eng201935.pdf

Reference prepared on 17 September 2026.

Project note: These documents are designed to be easy to index in a document/RAG pipeline. The section labels, summaries, and implementation notes are intended to support retrieval and system demonstrations; the underlying statute remains the authoritative legal source.